

be added to the rural road network.

In the social sector, many welfare schemes have been initiated for the poor, destitute, widows, freedom fighters and women for making their life comfortable. We are taking full care of the Scheduled Castes, Backward Classes



the last election, the INLD had got 26.8 per cent votes and only nine seats, but this time, they have got 25.6 per cent votes but have been able to win 31 seats.

How will you handle power problem which is causing great resentment among people?

On the power front, we will accelerate work on projects so that Haryana can become power surplus. The state government has got, in principle, approval from the Centre for setting up the first nuclear power project at Gorakhpur village in Fatehabad district. The work on the nuclear power station, in which an investment of Rs 12,000 crore is involved in the first phase, will start soon. We will ensure completion of the ongoing power projects, in or before time, which will add 5,000 MW to the state kitty and make it power surplus. My government had inherited the problem of shortage of power when we assumed office in 2005. At that time, the power generation in the state was 1,587 MW. When we took over, only one power project had been set up in the state in 40 years. In the last four-and-a-half years, we have initiated work on four power projects. The 600 MW Chhotu Ram Thermal Plant, Yamunanagar, has started generating power. The other power projects being set up include the Rajiv Gandhi Thermal Power Project, Khedar, Hisar, whose first unit will start production in December 2009 and the second will be completed by March 2010. The first two units of the Indira Gandhi Super Thermal Power Project, Jhajjar, will be completed by 2010 and the third by 2011. Similarly, the first and second units of the 1,320 MW Mahatma Gandhi Thermal Power Project, Jhajjar, will start production by 2011 and 2012, respectively.

What steps are you taking to motivate farmers to increase farm production?

The government will ensure timely availability of quality inputs and agricultural implements. Special attention will be paid to the post-harvest management of crops and marketing. During the kharif season, Haryana was severely affected because of deficient rainfall. The government addressed this unforeseen challenge in an effective manner. As a result, in spite of the rain gods failing, the state is expected to achieve a bumper kharif crop.

How is Haryana doing on the fiscal front?

Haryana is one of the fastest growing economies in the country. To mention just one indicator of the progress made by the state, its plan size increased from Rs 2,108 crore in 2004-05 to Rs 10,942 crore in 2009-10, which represents an increase of 419 per cent. However, we will introduce austerity measures to cut avoidable expenditure.

What measures are you taking to raise the standard of education?

Besides expanding educational facilities, the focus will be on improving the quality of education at all levels. For promoting science education, a Science Education Mission will be set up. Focus would also be on development of communication and soft skills in students. To streamline and expedite the recruitment process of teachers, an independent Teachers' Recruitment Board will be constituted.

What steps are being taken to improve the health facilities?

The state has embarked upon an ambitious programme of creating additional health infrastructure at the cost of Rs 1,500 crore. Some of the unique initiatives include free treatment of poor patients, free medicines to all OPD patients and emergency cases, a hassle-free cost-effective surgery package, a rolling system to recruit doctors and induction of specialists.

What are your plans to provide shelter to the poor?

The Mahatma Gandhi Gramin Basti Yojana is the flagship programme of my government. Under this, residential plots of 100 sq yd each are being allotted to SCs, BCs and BPL families. As many as 6.43 lakh families will benefit from the scheme. A policy has been framed under which 15 per cent of the dwelling units will be provided to people belonging to the economically weaker sections at the cost not exceeding Rs 4 lakh per unit.

How do you plan to promote industrial growth in the non-NCR region?

Haryana has emerged as a preferred destination for industry. The government will promote industrial growth in non-NCR region by developing industrial infrastructure for balanced regional development.

and the poor, by providing them education and houses besides other help.

How has the voter reacted this time?

The people have given us mandate and have supported our policies of peace and development. We won the war but lost some battles. There were some internal factors which queered the pitch for us. We will introspect and try our best to remove the glitches. We thank the people once again for reposing faith in the programmes and policies of the Congress.

Will a strong opposition be a threat to government?

A strong opposition is an asset in a democracy and we also look upon it as such. I hope the opposition parties will play a constructive role in speedy development of the state. The INLD vote share has gone down by one per cent. In